

On 21 June 2022, the department released a Notice of Intention to conduct a Biosecurity Import Risk Analysis (BIRA) under the Biosecurity Act 2015 and the Biosecurity Regulation 2016, in relation to the importation of live sturgeon for aquaculture. This commenced a 30-month timeframe to complete the BIRA.

We have published the final BIRA report and completed the BIRA. Development of the import conditions will now commence and is expected to take some time.

BIRA: Biosecurity Import Risk Analysis

SAG: Scientific Advisory Group

IGB: Inspector-General of Biosecurity

The above timeline is based on the BIRA process as outlined in the Biosecurity Import Risk Analysis Guidelines 2016. Learn more about the [BIRA Guidelines](#).

Steps to complete this risk analysis

When we do a risk analysis, we:

- review the science on pests and diseases of concern, release an Issues Paper, and seek stakeholder feedback on hazards
- assess and analyse biosecurity risks
- develop proposed risk management measures
- consult stakeholders on the draft report and then review comments
- publish a final report
- develop import conditions
- publish import conditions in our Biosecurity Import Conditions System (BICON).

About this risk analysis

At the request of industry stakeholders, we are assessing the biosecurity risks associated with the import of live sturgeon (*Acipenser* and *Huso* species) for aquaculture.

As risk management measures have not been established for live sturgeon, we conducted this assessment as a Biosecurity Import Risk Analysis under the Biosecurity Act 2015.

Learn more about how and why the department conducts a [Biosecurity Import Risk Analysis](#) and our international obligations.

About the final BIRA report

The sturgeon BIRA has undergone rigorous scientific review. This includes public consultation, independent review by technical experts on fish diseases, and review by the scientific advisory group (SAG).

The final BIRA report details:

- diseases of biosecurity concern
- risk assessments for the identified diseases
- recommended risk management measures.

The final BIRA report identified disease agents that need specific risk management measures. These agents are:

- *Aeromonas salmonicida* salmonicida (typical strain)
- *Argulus alosae*, *Argulus coregoni*, *Argulus flavescens*, *Argulus foliaceus* and *Argulus stizostethii*
- cyprinid herpesvirus 3 (koi herpesvirus)
- *Ergasilus sieboldi*
- frog virus 3
- infectious haematopoietic necrosis virus
- *Polypodium hydriforme*
- spring viraemia of carp virus
- sturgeon alloherpesviruses
- sturgeon nucleocytoplasmic large DNA viruses
- viral haemorrhagic septicaemia virus
- *Yersinia ruckeri* (Hagerman strain only).

The final BIRA report recommends that live sturgeon can be imported into Australia, provided they comply with appropriate risk management measures. These measures include:

- sourcing from disease-free stocks
- sourcing from a premises under the supervision of the competent authority
- sourcing from a premises that only cultures sturgeon
- pre-export quarantine
- parasite treatment
- batch testing for disease agents
- egg disinfection
- post-arrival quarantine.

Download the final report

[Final report for the import of live sturgeon for aquaculture \(PDF 5.2 MB\)](#) [Final report for the import of live sturgeon for aquaculture \(DOCX 6.68 MB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#) for assistance.

Implementation of import conditions

Before an import permit application to import live sturgeon and their reproductive material for aquaculture purposes can be considered by us or the Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water (DCCEEW), several activities need to be completed and the final import

conditions published on our Australian Biosecurity Import Conditions (BICON) webpage. Please refer to the implementation statement for these activities.

The below timeline is based on the activities outlined in the implementation statement.

DAFF Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry.

DCCEEW Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water.

BICON Biosecurity Import Conditions system.

CITES Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora.

S & T Australian states and territories.

Download the implementation statement

[Sturgeon BIRA implementation statement \(PDF 725 KB\)](#) [Sturgeon BIRA implementation statement \(DOCX 2.78 MB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#) for assistance.

Supporting documents

Download report from the SAG

[SAG's report of their findings on the provisional sturgeon BIRA \(PDF 281 KB\)](#) [SAG's report of their findings on the provisional sturgeon BIRA \(40 KB\)](#)

Download previous versions of the sturgeon BIRA

[Provisional report for the import of live sturgeon for aquaculture \(PDF 5.23 MB\)](#) [Provisional report for the import of live sturgeon for aquaculture \(DOCX 6.67 MB\)](#)

[Draft report for the import of live sturgeon for aquaculture \(PDF 3.15 MB\)](#) [Draft report for the import of live sturgeon for aquaculture \(DOCX 5.80 MB\)](#)

Download the issues paper and notice of intention

[Issues Paper for the import of live sturgeon for aquaculture \(PDF 753KB\)](#) [Issues Paper for the import of live sturgeon for aquaculture \(DOCX 739KB\)](#)

Download submissions to the draft BIRA report and issues paper

Submissions that were not marked as confidential can be viewed on [Have Your Say - Importing live sturgeon for aquaculture](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#) for assistance.

Contact us

For more information about this risk analysis email abra@aff.gov.au

[Register as a stakeholder](#) to receive notices about animal biosecurity policy and risk reviews.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/policy/risk-analysis/animal/live-sturgeon-for-aquaculture>